

# a vendor recommendation memo (invented)

Before you draft: the competent line for each aspect is already written. After you draft: fill every row from the page.

| Aspect · target verb                 | The one element that decides competent                                                    | Where it is (page · ¶) | Self-score                                                                                                         | Sure?                                                            | Mold if not competent |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Needs analysis</b><br>analyze     | Breaks the business need into requirements and shows which requirement drives the choice. |                        | <input type="checkbox"/> not evident<br><input type="checkbox"/> approaching<br><input type="checkbox"/> competent | <input type="checkbox"/> sure<br><input type="checkbox"/> unsure |                       |
| <b>Option comparison</b><br>evaluate | Scores at least two vendors against the same stated criteria and reaches a verdict.       |                        | <input type="checkbox"/> not evident<br><input type="checkbox"/> approaching<br><input type="checkbox"/> competent | <input type="checkbox"/> sure<br><input type="checkbox"/> unsure |                       |
| <b>Recommendation</b><br>justify     | Recommends one vendor and gives the evidence, including why not the runner-up.            |                        | <input type="checkbox"/> not evident<br><input type="checkbox"/> approaching<br><input type="checkbox"/> competent | <input type="checkbox"/> sure<br><input type="checkbox"/> unsure |                       |
| <b>Risk</b><br>explain               | Names the main risk of the choice and explains how it will be reduced.                    |                        | <input type="checkbox"/> not evident<br><input type="checkbox"/> approaching<br><input type="checkbox"/> competent | <input type="checkbox"/> sure<br><input type="checkbox"/> unsure |                       |
| <b>Sources</b><br>identify           | Cites the sources for every factual claim in a consistent style.                          |                        | <input type="checkbox"/> not evident<br><input type="checkbox"/> approaching<br><input type="checkbox"/> competent | <input type="checkbox"/> sure<br><input type="checkbox"/> unsure |                       |

## Triage

|                       | Right / competent                                    | Wrong / not competent                                                         |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                               | <b>Top priority.</b> A wrong model, or evidence you think is there and isn't. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-prove it from the rule. | Not learned yet.                                                              |

## Trap tally — written work

| Mold               | In written work scored by a rubric                                                            | Your count |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Dropped element    | A required part of the task is missing or only implied.                                       |            |
| Wrong stem number  | Restates the prompt or the scenario instead of applying it.                                   |            |
| Adjacent category  | Meets a neighbouring aspect, not the one being scored.                                        |            |
| Inverted operation | Does a lower verb than asked — describes when told to analyze, recommends without justifying. |            |
| Absolute language  | Unsupported certainty; no limits, risks or conditions stated.                                 |            |
| Confusion set      | Uses the wrong framework, model, source or standard for the job.                              |            |
| Camouflage         | Length, headings or citations that look like the aspect but do not meet it.                   |            |

# STOP

Every aspect located · every aspect competent-and-sure · then submit.